

A 6 Week Randomized Double-Blind Placebo-Controlled Trial of Ziprasidone for the Acute Depressive Mixed State

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Abstract

Objective: To examine the efficacy of ziprasidone vs. placebo for the depressive mixed state in patients with bipolar disorder type II or major depressive disorder (MDD).

Methods: 73 patients were randomized in a double-blinded, placebo-controlled study to ziprasidone (40–160 mg/d) or placebo for 6 weeks. They met DSM-IV criteria for a major depressive episode (MDE), while also meeting 2 or 3 (but not more nor less) DSM-IV manic criteria. They did not meet DSM-IV criteria for a mixed or manic episode. Baseline psychotropic drugs were continued unchanged. The primary endpoint measured was Montgomery-Åsberg Depression Rating Scale (MADRS) scores over time. The mean dose of ziprasidone was 129.7±45.3 mg/day and 126.1±47.1 mg/day for placebo.

Results: The primary outcome analysis indicated efficacy of ziprasidone versus placebo ($p=0.0038$). Efficacy was more pronounced in type II bipolar disorder than in MDD ($p=0.036$). Overall ziprasidone was well tolerated, without notable worsening of weight or extrapyramidal symptoms.

Conclusions: There was a statistically significant benefit with ziprasidone versus placebo in this first RCT of any medication for the provisional diagnostic concept of the depressive mixed state.

Trial Registration: Clinicaltrials.gov NCT00490542

Citation: Patkar A, Gilmer W, Pae C-u, Vöhringer PA, Ziffra M, et al. (2012) A 6 Week Randomized Double-Blind Placebo-Controlled Trial of Ziprasidone for the Acute Depressive Mixed State. PLoS ONE 7(4): e34757. doi:10.1371/journal.pone.0034757

Editor: Marianna Mazza, Catholic University of Sacred Heart of Rome, Italy

Received: July 29, 2011; **Accepted:** March 5, 2012; **Published:** April 24, 2012

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Funding: The project described was supported by the National Center for Research Resources and the National Center for Advancing Translational Sciences, National Institutes of Health, through Grant Number UL1 RR025752. The content is solely the responsibility of the authors and does not necessarily represent the official views of the NIH. This study was funded by an investigator initiated research grant by Pfizer (Groton, CT, USA; Pfizer reference number: IIR GA 128000). Pfizer did not participate in the conduct of the study; in the collection, management, analysis or interpretation of the data; or in the preparation, or approval of this manuscript. Pfizer researchers were involved in helping to design the study, but final design decisions were made by the academic researchers. Pfizer received the final manuscript, but had no role in editing or revising it.

Competing Interests: Dr. Ashwin Patkar is a Consultant for Bristol-Myers Squibb, GlaxoSmithKline, and Reckitt Benckiser; he is on the Speaker's Bureau and received honoraria from Bristol-Myers Squibb, Cephalon/Alkermes, Pfizer, and Reckitt Benckiser; and has received Grant Support from National Institutes of Health (NIDA, NIAAA), SAMHSA, AstraZeneca, Bristol-Myers Squibb, Cephalon, Forest, GlaxoSmithKline, Janssen, Jazz Pharmaceuticals, Lundbeck, McNeil Consumer & Specialty Inc., Organon, Pfizer and Shire Pharmaceuticals. Dr. Prakash Masand is a consultant for Eli Lilly and Company, Pamlab, Pfizer Inc., Sanofi-Aventis, and Schering Plough; he is on the Speaker's Bureau for Eli Lilly and Company, Grey Healthcare, Forest Pharmaceuticals, GlaxoSmithKline, Insight Medical Communications, Janssen Cilag, and Pfizer Inc.; he also has stock ownership with Ono Therapeutics and Titan Pharmaceuticals. Dr. William Gilmer has received honoraria and a research grant from Pfizer, and served on their Speaker's Bureau. Dr. Ghaemi has received research grants from Pfizer and Sunovion and has provided research consultations for Pfizer and Sunovion. Dr. Chi-un Pae has served as a consultant for GlaxoSmithKline, Otsuka Korea Pharmaceuticals, Ltd., Eli Lilly and Company, AstraZeneca, Wyeth Korea; has served on the Speaker's Bureau for Sanofi-Aventis, Schering Plough, Eli Lilly and Company, GlaxoSmithKline, AstraZeneca, Lundbeck Korea, Wharfin Pharmaceuticals, Otsuka Korea Pharmaceuticals, and Wyeth Korea; and has received grants from the Ministry for Health, Welfare and Family Affairs, KISTEP, Catholic Medical Center, The Catholic University of Korea College of Medicine Alumni, Eli Lilly and Company, GlaxoSmithKline, Otsuka Korea Pharmaceuticals, and AstraZeneca. Dr. Antony Loebel is currently Executive Vice President for Clinical Research at Sunovion Pharmaceuticals. He was employed by Pfizer at the time the study was conducted. Drs. Michael Ziffra, Edward Pirok, Paul Vöhringer, Molly Mulligan, Tanya Logvinenko, and Ms. Megan Filkowski, Elizabeth Whitham, Sairah Thommi, and Niki Holtzman have no conflicts to disclose. The above-stated relationships do not alter the authors' adherence to all the PLoS ONE policies on sharing data and materials.

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